DRAFT

COM-005

Household Emergency Communication Plan

Decide how household members will reconnect, give each person a copy, and review the plan whenever contacts or care needs change.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Official instructions take priority. Follow evacuation, shelter, road-closure, and other protective instructions from the responsible public-safety agency. This plan does not replace official alerts or emergency services.

MAKE THE PLAN TOGETHER

1. **Choose two meeting places:** one just outside the home and one outside the neighborhood. Never travel there when officials say the route or area is unsafe.
2. **Choose an out-of-area contact.** Each person should know how to call or text that person. Do not assume any one method will always work.
3. **Plan for access and support.** Include transportation, mobility, equipment, medications, power, language, children, animals, and authorized pickup.
4. **Keep copies.** Put one in each wallet, school bag, go-bag, and vehicle without including unnecessary private information.
5. **Practice twice a year.** Update the plan after a move, school or job change, or change in household or care needs.

Household Emergency Communication Plan — continued

HOUSEHOLD CONTACTS

Person / role	Primary phone or method	Backup method / accessibility need
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Key contact	Name	Phone / method
Out-of-area contact	_____	_____
School / child care	_____	_____
Workplace	_____	_____
Caregiver / support person	_____	_____
Veterinarian / animal contact	_____	_____

Situation	Place / action
Outside-home meeting place	_____
Outside-neighborhood meeting place	_____
Alternate safe destination	_____
Primary evacuation transportation	_____
Backup transportation / driver	_____
Message everyone should send	“I am at _____. I am _____. Next update at _____.”

IF HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS ARE SEPARATED

1. **Follow** official instructions for your current location.
2. **Send** one short update with your name, location, safety status, and next action.
3. **Contact** the out-of-area person if household members cannot reach one another.
4. **Conserve** the battery: dim the screen, close unused apps, and retry later if networks are busy.
5. **Update** the contact whenever your location or plan changes.

Household Emergency Communication Plan — continued

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

Household's verified official source: _____

Responsible agency: _____ **Enrollment URL or phone:** _____
Verified with agency by: _____ **Date:** _____

- ☐ Every household member has the plan in a usable format.
- ☐ Children know which trusted adult may pick them up.
- ☐ Support people know when and how to assist.
- ☐ Everyone understands that silence may mean a network failure—not that an area is safe.

Plan reviewed together on: _____ **Next review:** _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Make a Plan”; FEMA, “Family Emergency Communication Plan.” Accessed September 25, 2026. Household and local fields must be completed and checked before use.